

Harish Kannan

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EDUCATION

George Washington University

Master of Science in Cybersecurity, GPA: 3.83/4.0

Washington, D.C

Aug 2023 – May 2025

Vellore Institute of Technology

Bachelor of Technology in Electronics and Communication Engineering

Chennai, India

Jul 2019 – Jul 2023

CERTIFICATIONS

Offensive Security Certified Professional (OSCP)

CompTIA Security+ CE

AWS Cloud Security Foundations

In Progress (Target: Sept 2025)

Jul 2024 - Jul 2027

May 2024

EXPERIENCE

Student Academic Assistant

George Washington University

Jan 2025 – May 2025

Washington D.C

- Mentored **40+ students** in **Network Security** with lectures and labs on **TCP/IP, DNS, firewalls, IDS/IPS & VPNs**.
- Led **incident response simulations** on **threat detection, analysis and mitigation** using industry-standard security tools.
- Evaluated **projects/exams** and **provided feedback** to strengthen technical accuracy and problem-solving skills.

Cybersecurity Engineer

GURU Information Technology Services Pvt Ltd.

Oct 2022 – Mar 2023

Remote

- Conducted **vulnerability assessments** and **threat hunting** on web apps, APIs and cloud containers using Nessus, Burp Suite, Arachni and Nmap, identifying **15+ critical flaws** (SQLi, XSS, CSRF).
- Managed **vulnerability lifecycle** across SDLC, applied CVSS scoring, coordinated remediation and validated patches, cutting resolution time **by 30%** and improving **security operations efficiency**.
- Authored **SIGMA rules** and reverse-engineered malware with **Ghidra/IDA Pro**, improving SOC detection accuracy and reducing false positives **by 20%**.
- Triageed and escalated security alerts in **24x7 SOC** using Splunk, Elastic SIEM, MITRE ATT&CK, cutting downtime by 40%.
- Developed **IR playbooks, SOPs and automation workflows** aligned with **NIST, Zero Trust & PCI DSS**, recommending efficiency improvements and standardizing cross-team processes.
- Researched emerging threats via **15+ security communities** and **CTFs**, delivering **threat intelligence reports** and supported **AI-driven anomaly detection initiatives** to enhance defense posture.

PROJECTS

Red Team Simulation (CTF) | Metasploit, Nmap, Mimikatz

Jan 2025 - May 2025

- Orchestrated a **cyber kill chain attack** in a CTF exercise, performing reconnaissance with **Nmap**, exploiting MS08-067 and Icecast, pivoting with **PsExec** and achieving **domain persistence** via a forged Kerberos golden ticket.

Elastic SIEM | Elastic Stack (Elasticsearch, Kibana & Logstash), Tines

Oct 2024 - Jan 2025

- Engineered a **centralized SIEM** environment with custom Kibana dashboards and real-time correlation rules, cutting **Mean Time to Detect (MTTD) by 20%** and improving alert prioritization. Integrated with Tines for alert automation.

Network Traffic Analyzer | Python, Wireshark, Scapy

July 2024 - Sept 2024

- Designed a **packet inspection tool** to flag downloads from blacklisted sources, integrating **IP geolocation** and **automated logging** features to strengthen **threat hunting** workflows and research visibility.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Python, Bash, PowerShell, SQL, Java, C, C++, Go, HTML, JavaScript

Cloud and Containerization: AWS (EC2, IAM, S3, CloudWatch), Azure

Security Tools: Splunk, Elastic Stack (ELK), Cortex XSOAR, SentinelOne, Burp Suite, Nessus, Nmap, Wireshark, Metasploit, Ghidra, Snort, Suricata, TCPdump, Arachni, Netcat, Snyc, Tines

Network Security: TCP/IP, DNS, DHCP, VLAN, Firewall, IDS/IPS, WAF, VPN, SSL/TLS, DLP, DDoS Mitigation, SASE

Security Frameworks: MITRE ATT&CK, NIST, ISO 27001, SOC 2, PCI DSS, Zero Trust, Cyber Kill Chain, STIX/TAXII

ACTIVITIES & LEADERSHIP

Active CTF & Hackathon Participant - Ranked **Top 5%** (Snyk CTF), **Top 7%** (TryHackMe CTF)

Top 2% Ranking on TryHackMe

Operations Lead: Women in CyberSecurity GWU (WiCyS)

Technical Team Lead: CYSCOM VIT Chennai (OWASP)

Aug 2020 - Present

Sep 2024 - Present

Jan 2024 - Present

Dec 2020 - Dec 2022